



PC4x4SAR | Trip Planning Quick Reference

piercecounity4x4sar.org | Download full guide at piercecounity4x4sar.org/safety

EMERGENCY

CALL 911

BEFORE YOU GO

- ❑ **Weather:** Check forecast for destination + route
- ❑ **Trail conditions:** Closures, washouts, snow levels
- ❑ **Trip plan filed:** Route, timeline, vehicle, return time
- ❑ **Ten Essentials:** Packed and checked
- ❑ **Phone:** 100% charged, offline maps downloaded
- ❑ **Power bank:** Charged and packed
- ❑ **Vehicle:** Full tank, spare tire, tow strap
- ❑ **Extra food/water:** At least 1 extra meal + 1L water
- ❑ **Clothing:** Layers for 20 deg F colder than forecast
- ❑ **Backup plan:** Alternate destination identified

AT THE TRAILHEAD

- ❑ Sign in at trailhead register
- ❑ Note parking location + take photo
- ❑ Confirm turnaround time with group
- ❑ Final gear check: water, food, layers, nav, light
- ❑ Assess conditions -- turn back if needed

ON THE TRAIL

- ❑ Stay on marked trails
- ❑ Check map regularly, not just when lost
- ❑ Stick to turnaround time -- no exceptions
- ❑ Drink and eat regularly before you feel hungry
- ❑ Pace to slowest group member. Stay together.
- ❑ Monitor weather -- head back if it turns

COMMUNICATION PLAN

- ❑ **Emergency contact:** Name + phone filed with plan
- ❑ **Overdue protocol:** Contact calls 911 if no check-in by [time]
- ❑ **Satellite 911:** Free for all carriers via T-Mobile
- ❑ Sign up: t-mobile.com/satellite-911
- ❑ **Cell phone:** Try 911 even with no bars
- ❑ Text 911 if call fails (uses less signal)

WHEN YOU RETURN

- ❑ Sign out at trailhead register
- ❑ Notify emergency contact you're safe
- ❑ Report trail hazards to land manager
- ❑ Restock emergency kit supplies used

REMEMBER

The backcountry doesn't care about your schedule. Always tell someone your plans. If you're overdue and they call 911, we start looking along your planned route. Be there when we arrive.